

Response: Remember your mercy, Lord.

GOSPEL READING: Matthew 21: 28-32

Jesus said to the chief priests and the elders of the people:

'What is your opinion? A man had two sons. He went and said to the first,

"My boy, you go and work in the vineyard today".

He answered, "I will not go", but afterwards thought better of it and went.

The man then went and said the same thing to the second who answered, *"Certainly, sir", but did not go. Which of the two did the father's will?'*

'The first' they said. Jesus said to them,

'I tell you solemnly, tax collectors and prostitutes are making their way into the kingdom of God before

you. For John came to you, a pattern of true righteousness, but you did not believe him, and yet the tax collectors and prostitutes did. Even after seeing that, you refused to think better of it and believe in him'.



For this **112th World Day for Migrants and Refugees**, the theme, *"Even just one of these children,"* draws our attention to the minors directly involved in the experience of migration and flight, to the care owed to them, and to the Lord's promise that *"whoever receives one such child in my name receives me"* (Mk 9:37). Minors are the most vulnerable group within the global movements of migration. They are concrete faces, who have unique stories, and call on our conscience. Every year, millions of children and adolescents are forced to leave their homeland because of war, poverty, violence, environmental disasters and other tragedies. Sadly, their number continues to grow. The economic, political and military consequences of this disaster are immense. The suffering of migrant children does not end with their relocation. There are very young children who have lost parents, brothers, sisters and friends, and who have witnessed unspeakable acts of violence. Others, separated from their families for long periods, try to reunite with them while enduring the anguish of separation. There are also minors who make the journey together with their parents, yet are exposed to extreme and traumatic conditions. Finally, we cannot forget the tragic situation of those separated from their parents because of repatriation. To this already appalling situation are added further tragedies: deaths along migration routes, trafficking and exploitation, the recruitment of minors for use in armed conflicts, sexual violence, forced marriages, and the atrocities they have suffered or witnessed during their travels. Their dignity is trampled upon in countless ways. In his message to mark World Day of Migrants and Refugees for 2017, Pope Francis recalled that migrant children *"in a threefold way are defenceless: they are children, they are foreigners, and they have no means to protect themselves. I ask everyone to help those who, for various reasons, are forced to live far from their homeland and are separated from their families."*

Continued overleaf/....

SUNDAY REFLECTION ON THE READINGS

(Ezekiel 18:25-28; Philipians 2:1-11; Matthew 21:28-32).

Today's readings bring us face to face with one of the most important truths in the spiritual life: *God is not impressed by empty words, but by converted lives.*

In the first reading, through the prophet Ezekiel, God speaks clearly: if the wicked person turns away from sin and does what is right, he will live; but if the righteous person turns away from righteousness and does evil, he will die. The message is simple: *what matters most is not where we started, but where we are going now.* God is always ready to forgive, always ready to restore, always ready to give a new beginning. No one is too far gone for mercy, and no one can boast as though they are already safe without perseverance.

St. Paul in the second reading gives us the beautiful model of this new life: Jesus Christ Himself. The road of Christian greatness must include humility, self-emptying, and obedience. In a world where people want to be seen, promoted, praised, and admired, Christ shows us another way - the way of service.

The Gospel then drives the lesson home with the parable of the two sons. One son said "No," but later changed his mind and went. The other said "Yes," but never went. Jesus asks the chief priests and elders a piercing question: *'Which one did the will of the father?'* The answer is obvious: not the one who spoke nicely, but the one who actually obeyed.

This is a word for all of us. It is not enough to say "Lord, Lord." It is not enough to make promises in prayer, at Mass, or in public. God wants action.

He wants conversion.

He wants obedience that shows up in daily life - in our homes, our work, our relationships, and our moral choices.

Peace be with you.

8.00am: Anna Devine (A)
10.00am: Alice Burke (B'day Rem)

Tuesday, 29th September - Ss Michael, Gabriel & Raphael, Archangels

8.00am: Angela Rea (9th A)
10.00am: Juan Goncalves (A)

8.00am: Manuel & Celira Cardoso (Thanksgiving)
10.00am: John Ward (A)

8.00am: No Intention
7.30pm Curry: No Intention

8.00am: No Intention
10.00am: Conor Molloy (Deceased)
7.30pm: No Intention

8.00am: No Intention
10.00am: Daniel Dennigan (A) & DFM

7.30pm Vigil: Annie Monks (A)
Mary & George Dowd & their sons Michael, Jimmy & Francie (A)

8.00am: Mass for People of the Parish (Missa Pro Populo)

10.00am: Mary Henry (A)
Molly Lynch (A)
Mary Morgan (MM) & her son Brendan (A)

11.30am: Teresa Brady (A)
John & Cecelia Nevin (A)
Brian & Catherine Grant (A)

1.00pm: Dermott Gray, Marian Gray & Bridget Tyrell (A)
Martin Lowry (A)
Vincent & Sheila Crossan (A)

6.00pm: No Intention

BAPTISM: It is with great joy we welcomed Darla-Mae Elizabeth O’Leary–Maguire into the Christian community last weekend.

CONGRATULATIONS to Ciana Brady and Cathal Burke who gave themselves to each other in holy matrimony during the week.

† **RECENTLY DECEASED** We remember in our prayers Frank Kenny (Cloncoose) whose funeral took place during the week. May his soul, and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace.

REMINDER: Introduction to PARISH FUNERAL MINISTRY commences this **Wednesday 30th September** for 3 consecutive Wednesday nights - tea/coffee at 7pm, workshop at 7.30pm.

CONFESSIONS will be heard on **Thursday 1st October** - 10.30am-11.30am and 7.00pm-7.30pm.

FIRST FRIDAY calls will take place on **Thursday and Friday**. Please contact the Parish Office 043 33 46465 before Thursday if you would like a priest to call with Holy Communion.

BAPTISM MEETING will take place on Friday evening, **2nd October** at **8pm** for those who have a child for Baptism in the coming months.

ANOINTING OF THE SICK will be administered to those who may desire to receive it during the 10am mass on **Saturday 3rd October.**

BLESSING OF FAMILY PETS You are warmly invited to bring along your family pets for a special blessing on **Sunday 4th October at 3pm** in the Portico of the Cathedral. Please pass on this invitation parish to your neighbours, friends and family. We look forward to seeing all creatures - great and small – and ask that owners are careful to keep their pets and others safe and secure on the day.

LONGFORD ALZHEIMER CAFÉ hold their next monthly meeting on **Wednesday 30th September @ 7pm** in their office on Earl Street.

Continued from back page/

Yet, amid so much darkness, the light of solidarity is not lacking. Individuals, families, civil institutions and ecclesial communities choose ‘*not to pass by on the other side*’ (cf. Lk 10:29-37). We think of the families who open the doors of their homes in order to restore to these children the warmth of a family hearth; the educators who serve in reception centres; the volunteers and aid workers who each day devote themselves to healing the invisible wounds of these little ones along migration routes and in our cities. They bear witness through their commitment that love can overcome indifference.



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Mass Intentions – Mohill

Sat 3 19.30 Sean, Christina & Charles O'Beirne

Sean Rehill & DFM

Sun 4 10.00 Fran McGuinness & DFM

Eslin 9.00 Jim & Rosaleen Foley, Thomas Conlon

Sick and housebound will be visited at the usual times this Friday

We pray for Johanna Gilbert, Bridie Duignan, Coolebawn, Bridie Casey, Springfield and Noel Butler Corafora, Eslin whose funerals took place during the week. May they rest in peace,

Mass Times 3rd & 4th October

Sat Oct 3rd Fenagh 6.00pm

Mohill 7.30pm.

Sun Oct 4th Eslin 9.00am

Mohill 10.00am

Gortletteragh 11.30am

Weekday Masses

Mon to Fri 10am

Rosary after 10am Mass

Confession—Sat evening 7pm in Mohill.

at—Mass at 10am & Confessions after Mass

Eucharistic Adoration

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Thurs after 10am Mass until 6pm

Benediction first Thurs of the month at 6pm

. Offertory Collection Mohill €1,510

Mass Intentions – Fenagh

Sat 27 18.00 Pat, Roseann & Bernadette

Wynne & DM Wynne & Quinn Families

Tomas Flynn & DFM

Sat 4 18.00 DM Doherty Family Drumany

Frank Guckian & DFM

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament

Friday evening from 6 to 8pm in St Mary's Church, Foxfield

Offertory Collection Fenagh

Sept 19€695

Sick and Housebound will be visited at the usual times on Thurs

Fenagh	October 2026
Altar Society	Margaret Walpole Patricia Dolan
Eucharistic Minister	Doreen Honeyman
Reader	Sean O'Rourke
Collector	Noel McLoughlin

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Mass Intentions

Gortletteragh

ond & Ann Reynolds & DM Reynolds & Murphy Families

Sun 4 11.30

Offertory Collection

Gortletteragh€625

Fr. John Quinn will say Mass at 12 noon in Gortletteragh Church this week on Monday, Wednesday, Thursday and Friday. **No Mass on Tuesday,**

Those usually attended on the First Friday will again have Holy Communion brought to them at the usual times.

Counters for Oct

Geraldine McGowan, Mary Duffy & Patricia Boham, collection counted after 11.30am Mass

Holidays

I will be on holidays from Mon Oct 5 to Fri Oct 23. During this time for funerals and sick calls contact Fr Sean Burke 086 3679681 or Fr Livinus 087 4685121

"Gortletteragh Community Childcare Kids Tractor Run will take place this Sunday 27th of September at 12.30 in Gortletteragh GAA Pitch. Tractors scooters, ride ons, bikes or walking/ running. Entry is € 10 per child with vehicle or €20 per family. Refreshments served and a Raffle. All support greatly appreciated! All proceeds go towards Gortletteragh Community Childcare.

Ministries for October 2026
Altar Society
Helen Faughnan Lourda McGowan
Eucharistic Ministers Saturday
Rose Keegan
Eucharistic Ministers Sunday
Kathleen Cashin
Readers: Saturday
Denis McGeoghan
Readers: Sunday
Regina O'Carolan
Collectors: Saturday
Gerry McHugh, Gerry Beirne Francis McGowan, Patrick Beirne

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ADDRESS

MAIN STREET,
MOHILL,
N41 YR86

PHONE

+353 71 963 1024

EMAIL

info@mohillparish.ie

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ST. MARY'S CHURCH, BOHERQUILL

email: mcdcoath@gmail.com

FR. PIERRE MOBILE: 087 6960542



WEEKDAY MASSES

Tuesday

Boherquill – 9.30 am

Wednesday

Rathowen – 9.30am

Thursday

Rathowen – 9.30am. Adoration 10-10.30am

Friday

Boherquill – 8pm. Adoration 7 – 8pm.

WEEKEND MASSES 26th/27th

Sat 26th: No intention

Sun 27th: Josephine McNamara M/M. Patarica Moran
Ann Grimes.

WEEKEND MASSES 3rd/4th

Sat 3rd: No intention

Sun 4th: Marcella Farrell, Fairyhall. Ambrose/ Rosemarie
MaGuire

NEWS HEADLINES

A: Pope Leo in France will find a secular country at odds with Catholic teaching on life. **B:** Urgent need to address dangers: American bishops meet AI representatives. **C:** New convert and author says French Catholics have now learnt from Islam to be proud of their faith. **D:** Catholic university works to preserve Lebanon's Christian past, for the future. **E:** 600,000 sign up for Pope Leo's Paris mass, as organisers expand route. **F:** UK bill proposes to lift historic restrictions on Catholic and Jewish Prime Ministers. **G:** 800 years after St Francis' death, new digital project preserves his basilica for years to come. **H:** Vatican children's hospital: No one in Europe, No 4 in the world according to new ranking. **I:** A Muslim father tried to burn his daughters alive for becoming Christians. **J:** Catholic church in Germany contributes €595 million in international aid in 2025.

LEGION OF MARY.

The annual Legion of Mary pilgrimage to Knock takes this weekend, Sunday 27th. Devotion begins with the anointing of the sick at 2.30pm, followed by mass and the rosary procession at 3pm. A bus will leave Sunday morning from the Bay Horse Granard at 8am and the Parkhouse Edgeworthstown at 8.15am. To reserve a seat call Kitty on 086-0405621 or Peter 087-6613510.

SAINTLY WISDOM 'HOPE'

"Hope always draws the soul from the beauty that is seen to what is beyond, always kindles the desire for the hidden through what is perceived". .. St Gregory of Nyssa.

"The most hopeful people in the world are the young and the drunk: the first because they have little experiences of failure, and the second because they have succeeded in drowning theirs"..... St Thomas Aquinas

Hide yourself in Jesus crucified, and hope for nothing except that all men be thoroughly converted to his will. That all may be truly free"..... St Paul of the cross.

REST IN PEACE: The prayers of the church are asked for the repose of the soul of Diana Reilly (née Riggs) England and Rathowen, Daughter of Frank and Eithna Riggs, who died during the week. May she rest in peace.

BLESSING OF THE GRAVES 2027.

Russagh and Rathaspic Sat June 12th, (mass in Russagh)

Streete, Coolamber, Boherquill, Sat June 26th.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION 19th/20th Sept

A LITTLE THEOLOGY 'AGNOSTISM'

Agnosticism, defined as "the belief that nothing can be known about the existence of God or the supernatural". The church views this view as an error that limits human reason's capacity to know God through both natural logic and divine revelation. According to the Catechism of the Catholic Church agnosticism can take many forms firstly some agnostics make no judgement about God, declaring it is impossible to prove, affirm, or deny. Secondly, others accept a vague transcendent being, entirely hidden and incapable of being known or of revealing itself, lastly agnosticism that stems from an indifference, a sluggish conscience, or an active avoidance of life's ultimate question's. The church maintains that human reason can know God with certainty through creation, divine revelation & above all in Jesus Christ. We may experience doubt while in the pew, but this is not the same as agnosticism.

MEDJUGORJE PILGRIMAGE.

The annual pilgrimage to Medjugorje will take place from the 14th to the 21st of October, cost of the pilgrimage is €915, which includes flights from Knock airport, accommodation, breakfast and dinner taxes and transfers. The price is based on Per Person sharing Fr's PJ Huges and Jorom will accompany the group as spiritual directors. For more information or to reserve a place you can call Jerry on 087-4309096.

MAGNIFICA HUMANITAS.

One topic that seems to be becoming more and more of a matter of concern for all of humanity is the rapid development of AI, a tool which will be of immense benefit to humanity, but one that requires enlightened controls and a clear set of goals that ensure that it will be an instrument of peace and universal benefit. Pope Leo has written an encyclical letter entitled 'Magnifica humanitas' meaning the magnificent human, which set the person at the center of any development, the encyclical has been warmly received by many involved in AI research, and seen as a road map for ongoing progress. With just 100 pages it is accessible to everyone who is concerned and seeks guidance. Available from bookstation Ireland or from the Vatican website www.vatican.va.

